

ME 333
MECHANICS OF MATERIALS

Lecture 20: Unsymmetric Bending III & Shear Center

Ravi Sastri Ayyagari

Mechanical Engineering
Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

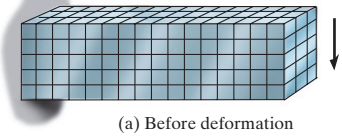
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026 1 / 24

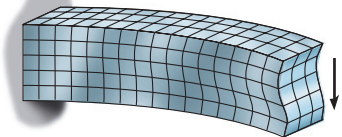
Stresses due to shear forces and bending moments

Stresses due to varying bending moments

Cantilever beam with shear force acting on the free end



(a) Before deformation



(b) After deformation

Assumptions :

- Bending stress distribution is valid even when the bending moment varies along the beam in presence of shear forces
- Satisfaction of geometric compatibility is omitted in the analysis - **engineering theory**
- Satisfaction of stress-strain relations is not included

Ref Base Fig: Statics & Mechanics of Materials, R. C. Hibbeler

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

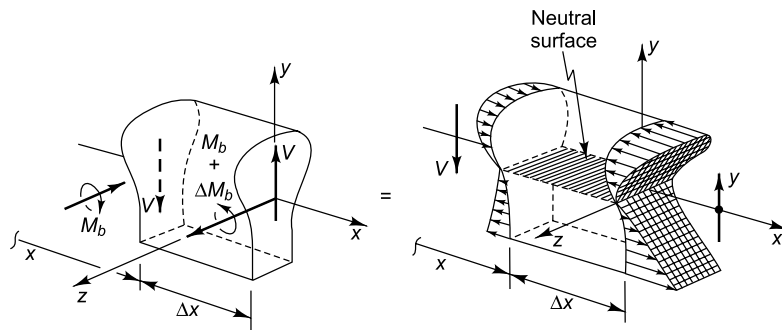
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026 2 / 24

Stresses due to shear forces and bending moments

Stresses due to varying bending moments

Shear forces in a symmetric beam



Ref Base Figs: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

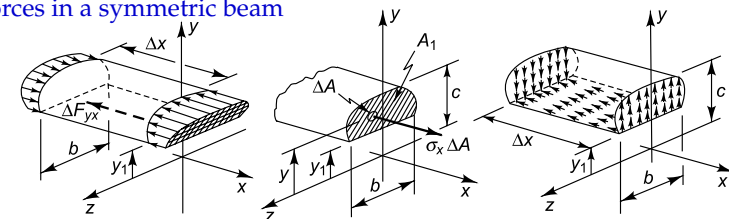
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026 3 / 24

Stresses due to shear forces and bending moments

Stresses due to varying bending moments

Shear forces in a symmetric beam



- Using static force equilibrium:

$$\Delta F_{yx} = -\frac{\Delta M_b}{I_{zz}} \int_A y dA$$

$$\frac{dF_{yx}}{dx} = \lim_{\Delta x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\Delta F_{yx}}{\Delta x} = -\frac{dM_b}{dx} \frac{1}{I_{zz}} \int_A y dA = \frac{V}{I_{zz}} \int_A y dA$$

Ref Base Figs: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

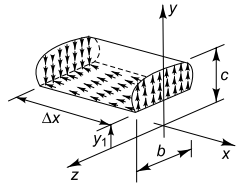
ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026 4 / 24

Shear stress distribution

Shear Flow q_{yx} is the resultant of shear stress τ_{yx} distributed across the width b of the beam.



- Assuming shear stress to be uniform across the beam :

$$\tau_{yx} = \frac{q_{yx}}{b} = \frac{VQ}{bI_{zz}} @ y = y_1$$

- Using Equilibrium equation:

$$\frac{\partial \sigma_x}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \tau_{xy}}{\partial y} = 0 \Rightarrow -\frac{\partial \tau_{xy}}{\partial y} = \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(\frac{-M_b y}{I_{zz}} \right) = \frac{V}{I_{zz}} y$$

$$\therefore - \int_{y_1}^{h/2} \frac{\partial \tau_{xy}}{\partial y} dy = \frac{V}{I_{zz}} \int_{y_1}^{h/2} y dy \Rightarrow -[\tau_{xy}]_{y_1}^{h/2} = \frac{V}{I_{zz}} [y^2/2]_{y_1}^{h/2}$$

$$\therefore \tau_{xy} = \frac{V}{2I_{zz}} [(h/2)^2 - y^2]$$

Shear stress is max at the neutral surface and falls off parabolically.

Ref Base Figs: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

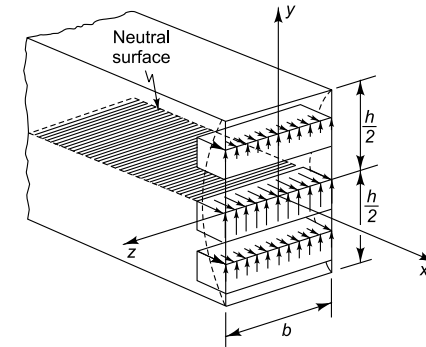
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

5 / 24

Shear stress distribution

Rectangular cross-sections : Shear stress is max at the neutral surface and falls off parabolically.



Ref Base Figs: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

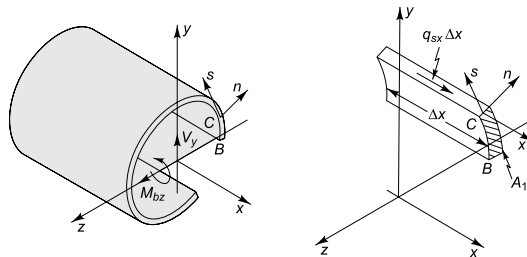
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

6 / 24

Unsymmetric Bending

In presence of shear forces (Open thin wall sections)



Assumption :

The stress distribution due to bending moments still remains:

$$\sigma_x = - \frac{(yI_{yy} - zI_{yz})M_z + (yI_{yz} - zI_{zz})M_y}{(I_{zz}I_{yy} - I_{yz}^2)}$$

Ref Base Figs: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

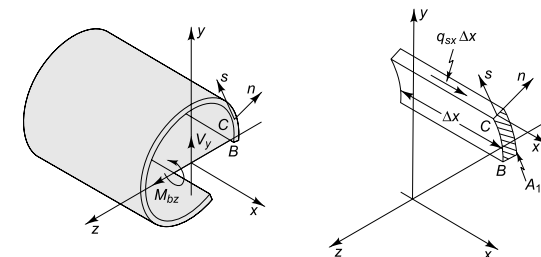
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

7 / 24

Unsymmetric Bending

In presence of shear forces (Open thin wall sections)



Applying static force equilibrium on segment BC :

$$q_{xs} = q_{sx} = \frac{-V_y}{I_{zz}I_{yy} - I_{yz}^2} \left(I_{yy} \int_{A_1} y dA - I_{yz} \int_{A_1} z dA \right)$$

Ref Base Figs: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

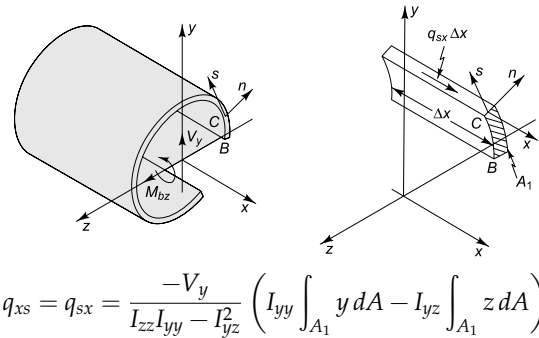
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

8 / 24

Unsymmetric Bending

In presence of shear forces (Open thin wall sections)



Q Where should the shear force act ?

Ref Base Figs: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

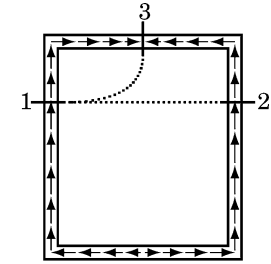
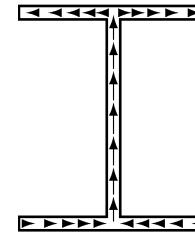
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

9 / 24

Unsymmetric Bending

Q Why open thin sections only ?



Ref Base Fig: Introduction to Solid Mechanics, Lubliner & Papadopoulos

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

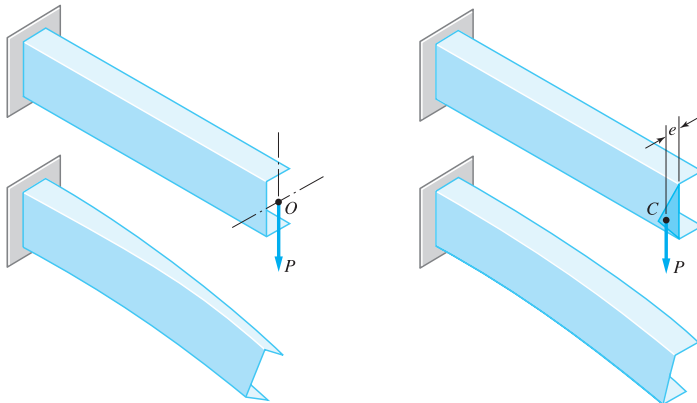
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

10 / 24

Shear Center

Loading of open thin sections



Ref Base Fig: Mechanics of Materials, Pytel & Kiusalaas

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

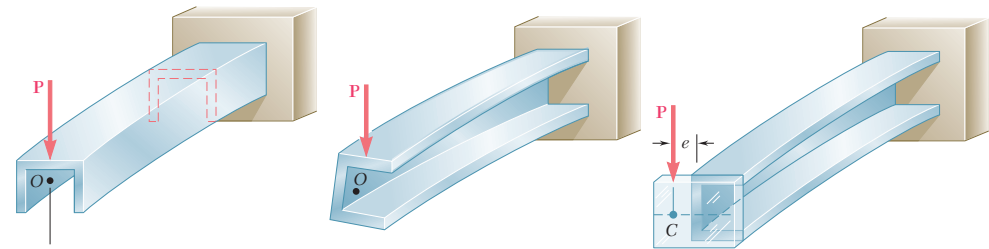
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

11 / 24

Shear Center

Loading of open thin sections



Shear Center (C) : It is the point about which if an external load is applied - it produces no twisting moment.

Ref Base Fig: Mechanics of Materials, Beer & Johnston

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

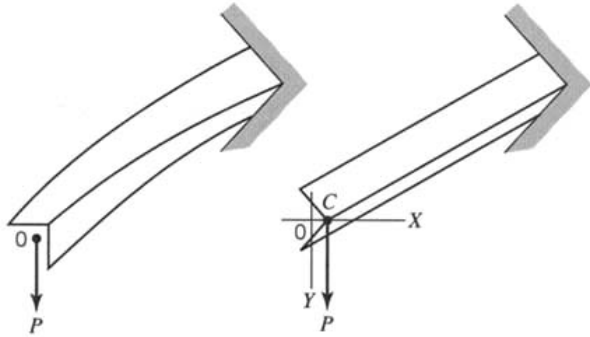
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

12 / 24

Unsymmetric Bending

Loading of open thin sections



Ref Base Fig: Advanced Mechanics of Materials, Borei & Schmidt

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

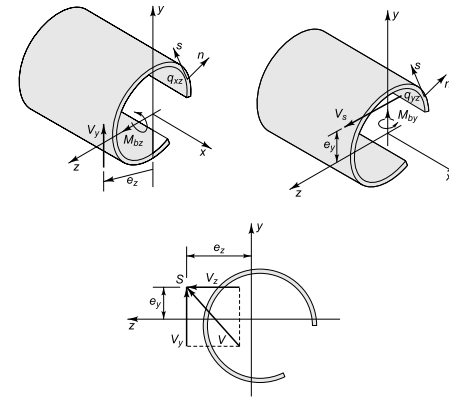
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

13 / 24

Unsymmetric Bending

Loading of open thin sections



Ref Base Figs: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

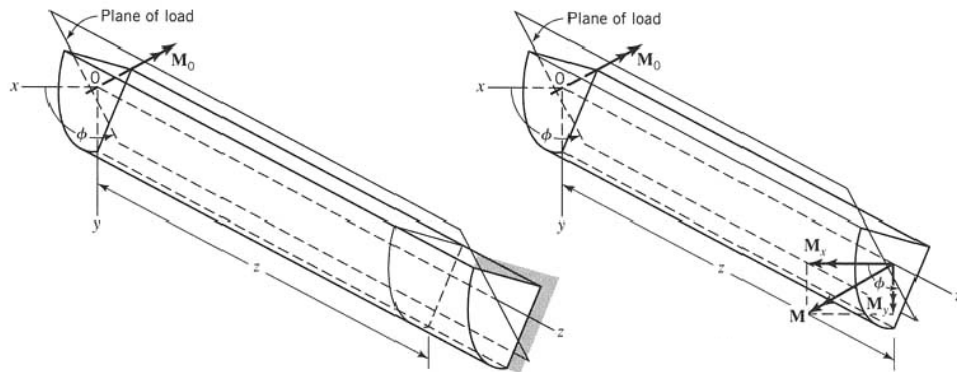
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

14 / 24

Unsymmetric Bending

Pure Bending Scenario:



Ref Base Fig: Advanced Mechanics of Materials, Borei & Schmidt

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

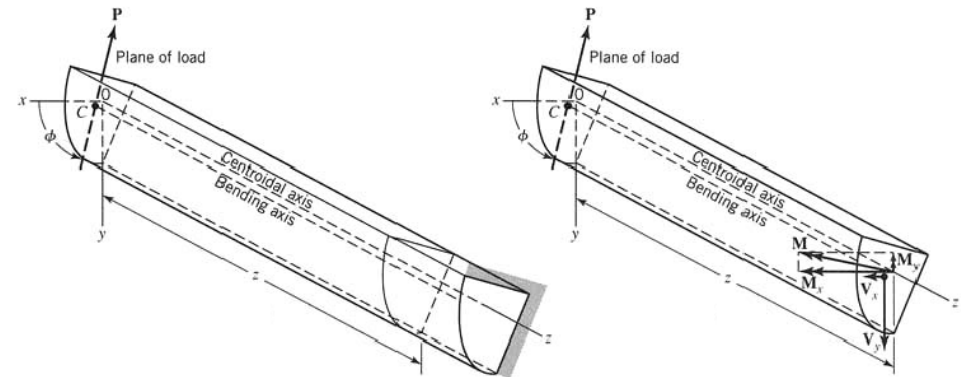
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

15 / 24

Unsymmetric Bending

Varying Bending Scenario:



Ref Base Fig: Advanced Mechanics of Materials, Borei & Schmidt

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

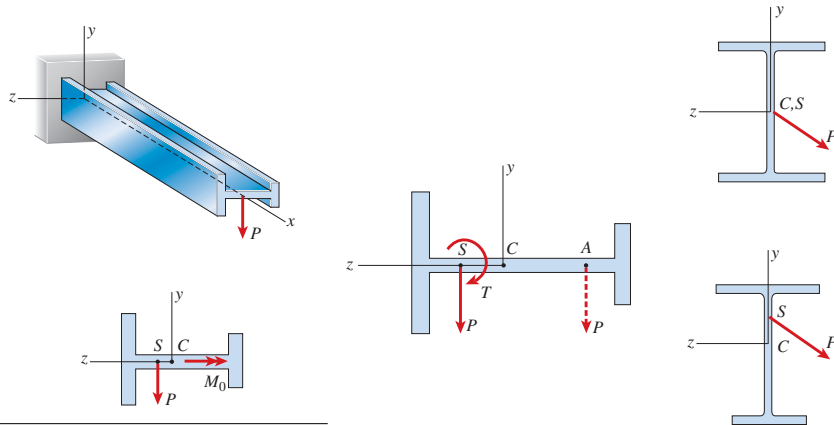
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

16 / 24

Shear Center

Centroid & Shear Center:



Ref Base Fig: Mechanics of Materials, Gere & Goodno
ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

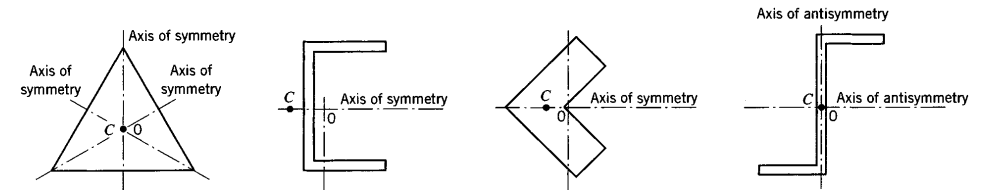
ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

17 / 24

Unsymmetric Bending

Beam cross-sections:



- When there are atleast two axis of symmetry or anti-symmetry the centroid of the cross-section coincides with the shear center.
- If there is an axis of symmetry the shear center lies on the axis of symmetry.

Q How to locate the shear center ?

Ref Base Fig: Advanced Mechanics of Materials, Boreasi & Schmidt

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

18 / 24

Shear Center : Applications



Ref Fig: Web

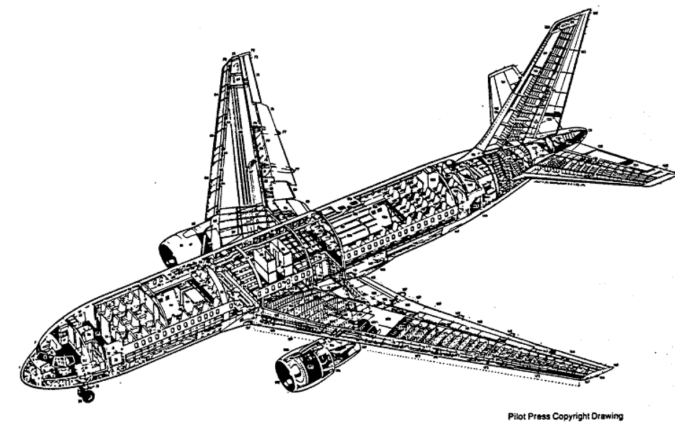
ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

19 / 24

Shear Center : Applications



Pilot Press Copyright Drawing

Ref Fig: Web

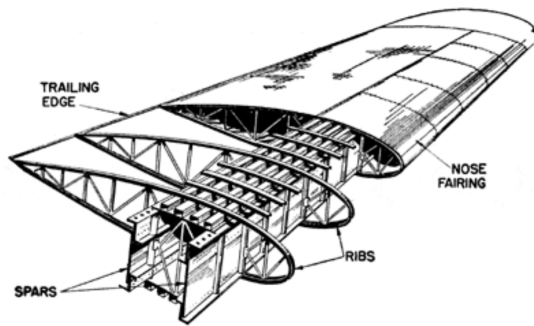
ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

20 / 24

Shear Center : Applications



Ref Fig: Web

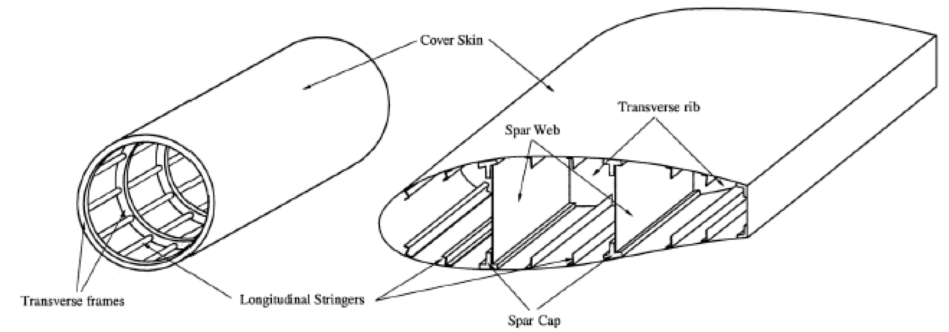
ravi.ayyagari@itgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

21 / 24

Shear Center : Applications



Ref Fig: Web

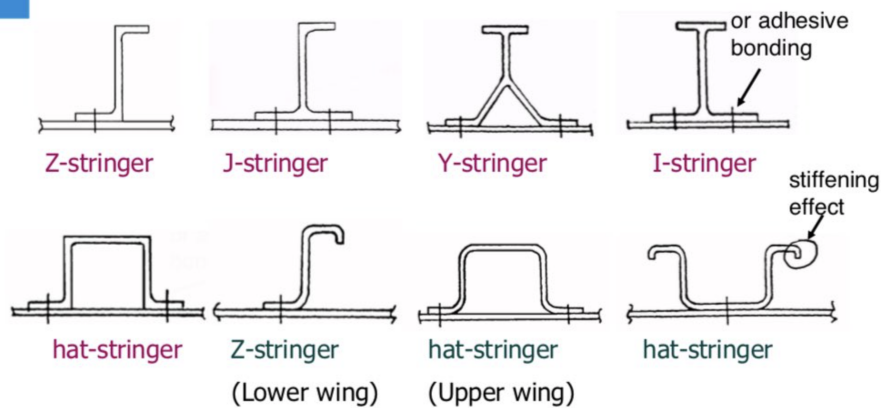
ravi.ayyagari@itgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

22 / 24

Shear Center : Applications



Ref Fig: Web

ravi.ayyagari@itgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

23 / 24

Reading Assignment

Chapter 7 : Crandall et. al.
 Chapters 7 & 8 : Boresi & Schmidt

ravi.ayyagari@itgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025 - 2026

24 / 24